The Three Questions

الأُصُولُ الثَّلَاثَةُ

Before you start

Goal	By the end, your child can say the three fundamental principles every Muslim must know (knowing their Lord, their religion and their Prophet ﷺ) and colour the date-palm page.
Time	About 15 to 20 minutes.
You need	The printed worksheet and colouring page, a pencil, crayons, paper and scissors for the game.
Pages	Worksheet "My Three Roots" and the date-palm colouring page. Answers: Answer Key, Lesson 3.

Background for you 2 minutes to read

Shaykh al-Islam Muhammad ibn Abdul-Wahhab wrote *Thalathat al-Usul* to teach these foundations. Shaykh Ibn Baz and Shaykh al-Uthaymeen both explained it. In this lesson your child learns the three foundations themselves; later lessons explain each one.

Say it like this Read the bold lines aloud, or say them in your own words.

Say: **Today we learn three foundations. A foundation is like the roots of a tree. Shaykh al-Uthaymeen said the roots are what the branches grow from.**

Say: **Every Muslim must know three things: who is my Lord, what is my religion, and who is my Prophet ﷺ.**

Say: **Shaykh Ibn Baz said these three gather the whole religion.**

Point to the coloring page.

Say: **Let's colour the three roots: Rabbī, Dīnī, Nabiyyī ﷺ.**

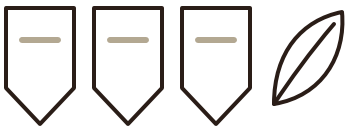
Say the Arabic words

الأُصُولُ الثَّلَاثَةُ	**al-u-SOOL ath-tha-LAA-tha**	the three (fundamental) principles
رَبِّي	**RAB-bee**	my Lord
دِينِي	**DEE-nee**	my religion
نَبِيِّي	**na-BEE-yee**	my Prophet ﷺ

Capital letters show the strong part of the word. "ee" as in *see*, "oo" as in *moon*, "aa" as in *father*, "th" as in *think*.

Review game: Root Match 5 minutes, paper and pencil only

1. Write رَبِّي, دِينِي, نَبِيِّي ﷺ on three paper "roots".
2. Say the English (my Lord / my religion / my Prophet ﷺ).
3. Your child puts a paper leaf on the matching root.



For parents. You can teach the whole lesson from this page. Page 2 has the scholars' words and answers to questions.

The Three Questions

الأُصُولُ الثَّلَاثَةُ

If your child asks...

"Why are they called roots?" Shaykh al-Uthaymeen explained that *usul* means foundations, like the root of a tree that the branches grow from (*Sharh Thalathat al-Usul*, Shaykh Muhammad ibn Salih al-Uthaymeen, Dar al-Thurayya, 4th ed., p. 42).

"Why only three?" Shaykh Ibn Baz said these three gather the whole religion (*Sharh Thalathat al-Usul*, Shaykh Abdul-Aziz Ibn Baz, Dar al-Masir, 1st ed., p. 38).

Answers to the three questions themselves come in the next lessons, from the scholars' explanations. Until then: "We will learn each one in the next lessons, in sha Allah."

From the Scholars

The scholars' own words, with the meaning in plain English and the book and printed page.

1. The three principles: the words of the original text, as quoted by Shaykh Ibn Baz

فَإِذَا قِيلَ لَكَ: مَا الأُصُولُ الثَّلاثَةُ التِي يَجِبُ عَلَى الإِنْسَانِ مَعْرِفَتُهَا؟ فَقُلْ: مَعْرِفَةُ الْعَبْدِ ربه ودينه ونبيه محمد صلى الله عليه وسلم.

Meaning of Shaykh Muhammad ibn Abdul-Wahhab's words: "If you are asked: what are the three principles every person must know? Say: that the servant knows his Lord, his religion and his Prophet Muhammad ﷺ."

Sharh Thalathat al-Usul, Shaykh Abdul-Aziz Ibn Baz, Dar al-Masir, 1st ed., p. 38

2. Why these three? Shaykh Ibn Baz

هذه الأصول الثلاثة تجمع الدين كله من ربك؟ وما دينك؟ ومن نبيك؟ وهي التي يسأل عنها العبد في قبره.

Meaning of Shaykh Ibn Baz's words: "These three principles gather the whole religion: Who is your Lord? What is your religion? Who is your Prophet? These are what a person is asked about in the grave."

Sharh Thalathat al-Usul, Shaykh Abdul-Aziz Ibn Baz, Dar al-Masir, 1st ed., p. 38

3. What "usul" means: Shaykh Muhammad ibn Salih al-Uthaymeen

الأصول جمع أصل، وهو ما يبنى عليه غيره، ومن ذلك أصل الجدار وهو أساسه، وأصل الشجرة الذي يتفرع منه الأغصان

Meaning of Shaykh al-Uthaymeen's words: "'Usul' means foundations: what other things are built on, like the foundation of a wall, or the root of a tree that the branches grow from."

Sharh Thalathat al-Usul, Shaykh Muhammad ibn Salih al-Uthaymeen, Dar al-Thurayya, 4th ed., p. 42

4. The ayah Shaykh al-Uthaymeen cites: Surah Ibrahim 14:24

أَلَمْ تَرَ كَيْفَ ضَرَبَ ٱللَّهُ مَثَلًا كَلِمَةً طَيِّبَةً كَشَجَرَةٍ طَيِّبَةٍ أَصْلُهَا ثَابِتٌ وَفَرْعُهَا فِي ٱلسَّمَآءِ ٢٤

Meaning of the ayah, from *The Noble Qur'an* **(Hilali-Khan):** "See you not how Allâh sets forth a parable? A goodly word as a goodly tree, whose root is firmly fixed, and its branches (reach) to the sky (i.e. very high)."

Surah Ibrahim 14:24. Arabic text: King Fahd Complex (Madinah) mushaf.